The R&AW is credited with significant accomplishments on the disarmament issue. Its role was not limited to generating intelligence and analysis; it also engaged with friendly counterparts to convey India's concerns and reservations on nuclear non-proliferation treaty.

Today, thanks to the enormous amounts of data available in the public domain, India's intelligence analysts can quickly review breaking issues around the world and provide the government with candid assessments of various situations.

A False Link between Hindus and Corruption

Wars are not always conducted on battlefields. Disinformation campaigns can also produce destructive results. When the Janata Party led by Morarji Desai came to power, the R&AW's activities were curtailed because of Desai's deep suspicion of intelligence agencies. Within a year, the socialist government was in disarray and the international press was flooded with reports of intense feuding within the political establishment. British spies stationed in Delhi drafted a report linking Hinduism with corruption and sin and this was leaked to the international press in the early 1980s.

R&AW analysts were surprised by the excitement in the global media over the leaked report and the poor interpretation of Hinduism that the agency believed was part of the UK's imperial hangover. According to the leaked report, corrupt behaviour in Indian society was linked to Hindu beliefs, which emphasises individual rather than collective redemption. A more damaging allegation in the report was that, 'In Hinduism, there is no good or evil as in the case of Christianity, Judaism and Islam.'